disappeared. From May 1881 to March 1882, Kinthup worked as a slave before taking refuge in a monastery as a novice monk. After several months of living as a monk, he received permission to go on a pilgrimage. He went to a place near the Tsangpo and spent many days cutting up 500 logs into a regular size. These he hid in a cave before returning to the monastery.

A few months later, he got permission to go to Lhasa on a pilgrimage. There he got a fellow Sikkimese to write the following message for his bosses at the Survey:

> 'Sir, The Lama who was sent with me sold me to a Djongpen (headman) as a slave and himself fled away with the Government things that were in his charge. On account of which the journey proved a bad one; however, I, Kinthup, have prepared the 500 logs according to the order of Captain Harman, and am prepared to throw them 50 logs a day into the Tsangpo from Bipung in Pemake, from the fifth to the fifteenth day of the tenth Tibetan month of the year called Chuhuluk, of the Tibetan calendar'. [19]

Kinthup did as he promised before returning to India. Unfortunately, the watch on the Brahmaputra had been abandoned by now and the letter arrived too late. Since we now know that the Tsangpo is indeed the Brahmaputra, the logs must have floated unnoticed down to Assam and then into Bengal. Kinthup, thus, did not receive the acclaim he deserved and he lived out his remaining life as a tailor in Darjeeling. Such was the world that inspired Rudyard Kipling to write tales of adventure like *The Man who would be King* and *Kim*.

THE LAST OF THE LIONS

Life in British India was not just about cartographic surveys and Victorian engineering. The British also enjoyed life in India. One of the popular pastimes of the rich and powerful was the hunt, particularly of tigers. According to Valmik Thapar, as many as 20,000 tigers were shot for sport between 1860 and 1960 by Indian princes and British hunting parties. Mahesh Rangarajan separately estimates that an overall 80,000 tigers may have been destroyed between 1875 and 1925, as they were considered dangerous and official bounties were paid for them. [20] Despite this